PROPOSED PROGRAM / VOLUNTARY FEDERAL ADVICE

National School Safety Innovation Forum

Local innovation should produce national learning. Establish a moderated, nationwide community of practice in which school administrators publish documented safety improvements, unsuccessful approaches, measured tradeoffs, and lessons learned. Build on existing DOJ STOP School Violence technical-assistance and peer-learning work rather than duplicating it.

GOVERNANCE RECOMMENDATION

School-led, federally advised, independently evaluated. Invite federal agencies to review technical methods and issue nonbinding recommendations. School districts retain legal authority for campus decisions; agency participation and sponsorship require formal agreement and do not imply federal certification.

01 / Network and access

Provide verified membership for public, Tribal, territorial, charter and private school leaders; include rural and urban districts, educators, families, accessibility specialists, responders and researchers. Offer moderated discussion, regional peer groups, quarterly workshops and an annual evidence review.

02 / Federal technical review

Request CISA advice on physical and cyber protection; USSS NTAC on behavioral threat assessment; DOJ BJA/NIJ on evaluations and replication; Education on student privacy and civil rights; and FEMA on exercises. Involve state education and safety agencies, including Washington OSPI.

03 / Evidence-based case library

Use a standard entry: problem, setting, countermeasure, lawful approvals, baseline, cost, implementation limits, test methods, outcomes, adverse effects and reproducibility. Label *proposed*, *locally tested*, *independently replicated* or *not recommended*. Publish useful failures as well as successes.

04 / Security, rights and trust

Separate public summaries from tightly restricted professional materials. Exclude identifiable student records, live incidents, floor plans, sensor gaps, armed-staff deployments and exploitable vulnerabilities. Require moderation, independent conflict-of-interest declarations, privacy review, correction and appeal procedures.

RECOMMENDED SHARING WORKFLOW

Submit	Screen	Federal / peer review	Evaluate	Publish / replicate

Launch proposal: Convene a 90-day charter group; invite written agency recommendations; pilot a secure case library and administrator peer-review program within six months; publish an annual public findings report and a restricted practitioner supplement. Measure independently verified improvements, adoption, cost, safety incidents and unintended effects—not message volume or product sales.

Basis: DOJ BJA STOP TTA (2023): communities of practice and dissemination; DOJ STOP School Violence Program; CISA K–12 School Security Guide (2022); USSS NTAC (2018). This forum is proposed, not an existing federally approved program.